TASK 5 CASE STUDY - PHISHING

phishing exists as a cybercrime which involves attackers who create fake identities as banks and government agencies to obtain personal information from their targets. The stolen information contains user login details together with credit card data and personal identification information which criminals use for identity theft operations. The criminal starts their attack by sending out mass messages which use official company logos to create fake business communications. The message contains an artificial emergency because it states users must prove their identity right away to stop their accounts from being deleted through the given link. The victim activates a link which leads them to a fake website that attackers created through spoofing. The site duplicates a real login page except the criminal maintains complete control over its operation. The attacker obtains victim credentials during the "harvest" phase which allows them to immediately seize all entering data. College students who operate various digital platforms become common targets for attackers because they tend to respond quickly to security alerts about their tuition payment systems. The results from these attacks produce severe damage because they immediately steal personal information which criminals use to conduct unauthorized financial operations. Organizations face the risk that one stolen credential will open their systems to a large data breach which will generate major business losses and damage their reputation.